Evan J. O'Grady

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EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles, Westwood, California — Expected September 2026

Master's Degree in Quantum Science and Technology

Relevant Coursework: Quantum Information, Quantum Optics Laboratory, Satellite Quantum Networking

Manhattan University, Riverdale, New York — May 2025

B.S. in Computer Engineering (Major GPA: 3.81)

- Magna Cum Laude, HKN Honors Society, Annual Presidential Scholarship, Epsilon Sigma Pi Honors, Dean's List

Relevant Coursework: Math Methods, Applied Electromagnetics, Electronics, Signals & Systems

SKILLS

Software: Python, QuTip, Qiskit, C, C++, Mathematica, Unix Shell, PyTorch, Git, LTSpice, HFSS

Technical: Experimental Optics, RF Electronics, Scientific Computing, Quantum Simulation, Quantum Algorithms, NMR Spectroscopy, Oscilloscopes, Circuit Analysis

PROJECTS

Acousto-Optic Modulated Laser Comm., UCLA MQST Lab — Spring 2026

- Designed and constructed a self-heterodyne interferometer setup with an AOM and a reference arm
- Programmed RF drive control and beat note detection using RFSoC 4x2 and QICK
- Demonstrated both Frequency-Shift and Amplitude-Shift Keying for information encoding

Quantum Programming Language Comparison, (Advisor: Dr. Jens Palsberg) — December 2025 – March 2026

- Helped develop a classification framework for quantum programming languages
- Wrote programs for Shor's algorithm and the quantum phase estimation subroutine in PennyLane and Q#
- Awaiting publication in ACM Computing Surveys

EXPERIENCE

Photonics Technologies Intern, The Aerospace Corporation — June 2026 – Present

- Assist with laboratory experiments on a fiber-based quantum networking testbed
- Simulate and construct optical setups for squeezed light generation
- Build control and automation software for characterization of a Rydberg atom-based electric field sensor
- Research novel deep learning methods for computational electromagnetics

Research Mentor, Nova Scholar Education — July 2025 - Present

- Guide high school students through the process of completing a research project
- Provide subject matter expertise to students interested in research related to engineering and computer science

National Science Foundation, Undergraduate Researcher (Advisor: Dr. Yi Wang) — May 2024 – May 2025

- Selected for the NSF's International Research Experience for Students (IRES) program in Zaragoza, Spain
- Investigated newest innovations in large language models, object detection, and speech recognition
- Developed a machine learning-based assistant for the visually impaired using Python

Section Leader, Stanford University's Code in Place — Summer 2025

- Taught fundamentals of python programming through one of the largest free computer science education initiatives in the world
- Successfully led a group of ~15 diverse students through the first half of Stanford's intro to Python course
- Gained interpersonal skills, practiced engaging pedagogy, and demonstrated mastery of Python principles

Tutor/Mentor, IEEE HKN Honors Society — August 2024 – May 2025

- Held weekly open tutoring hours for peer students in select math and electrical engineering courses
- Mentored two underclassmen in professional and academic advice